

NEW WAYS TO INFUSE TEA

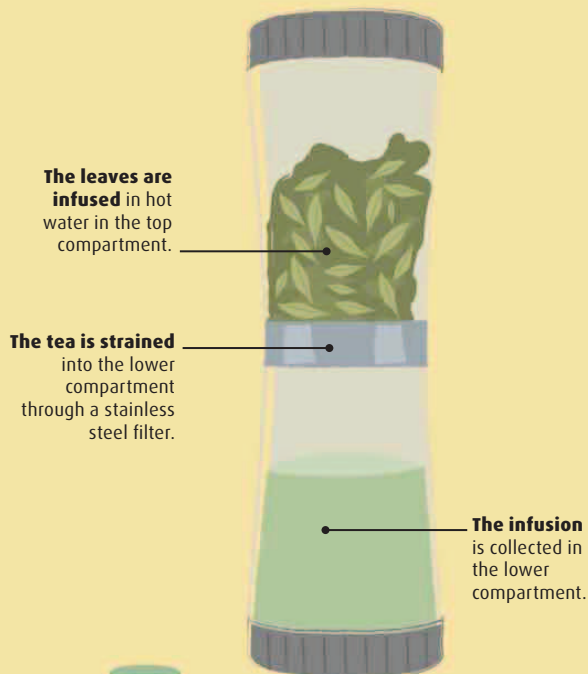
A number of innovative devices for infusing tea are now available. Some of them are simple and streamlined, others are eccentric, but they all produce a good cup of tea, and are well worth trying.

HOT INFUSERS

Traditionally, tea is infused with hot water, and leaves are processed with this in mind. There are now innovative alternatives to the conventional teapot that work equally well for infusion.

THE TEA SHAKER

This is a simple but brilliant concept. Composed of two compartments connected by a stainless steel filter, the tea shaker is similar to a classic hourglass. Place the tea leaves in the top compartment, add the hot water, and close the lid. Flip the device so it is upside down, and leave to infuse. After infusing for the required time, flip the device again and shake it from side to side to let the tea strain through the filter into the bottom compartment.



COLD INFUSERS

These devices are designed for a long steep, and allow the tea leaves to release their flavors slowly. While it may seem counterintuitive to the traditional practice of using hot water to draw out the tea's finest traits, cold infusion creates a lighter-bodied infusion, with a mellow, sweeter flavor. The method works particularly well with green and yellow teas, and is an inventive way of infusing Darjeelings.

SINGLE SERVE

This cold infuser comes in several shapes and is very easy to use. Place the dry leaves in the infuser and add cold water. Screw on the adapter with the built-in filter, and leave in the fridge to infuse for 2-3 hours. After that, pour the tea infusion through the adapter. Some infusers come with a removable infusion strainer, which holds the leaves, instead of a built-in filter. In such a case, remove the strainer before pouring.

